

SESSION KICKOFF • 2026-09-12

Paste this to open the next session. Written overnight 11 to 12 September at Stephen's housekeep. Replaces the 09-10 kickoff. Story crafting only; schedule and release stay out of it. One issue at a time, worst first, accept / challenge / answer.

Where we are

Premise v8.1 remains formally in force. The trusting-forgery premise survived six delta rounds with its device never broken; the churn was diagnosed and Stephen ruled the **three foundations** on 2026-09-11 (SAS/four-keys-foundations-2026-09-11.md): the money is the occasion, never the motive; Violet dies because of the mark on the panel, locked in a store that opens only on her death; after the second shelf she takes the key in and does not watch. Delta rounds are stopped.

Spine v2.0 is written and waiting for Stephen's read: SAS/episode-1-spine-four-keys-v2.0.md (PDF beside it). The full document, all parts, rebuilt from v1.4 with every surviving ruling of the six rounds as a row, a canon annex (Part G) so no omission reads as a hole, a new Fable brief (Part H), and the adversary prompt at the foot. It is marked DRAFT FOR ATTACK.

First: Stephen reads v2.0

Points to have his eye on, because they are new on the page or moved by the foundations:

1. **A1, Days –110 to –19.** Brad's decision is now sequenced: at –110 he decides to go early by the death he has prepared; at –40 he learns she is carrying his mark round the trade; the tin (–38) is the first attempt; at –19 she locks the panel in front of him and the plan is made. Is that the Brad he wants?
2. **A1, Days –37 to –29.** The lock (–36), the pot told to the four, the probe (–30), the key taken in (–29) and her sentence in the book. Foundation 3 as rows.
3. **A2, Day 1.** Liam breaks a pane because there is no spare. One glass. No board, no hook, no pale rectangle.
4. **A3, Days 45 to 55.** The estate thread as ruled: Margo tells the accountant everything about the money and nothing about a letter; the unpaid Civic Row account; Brad's oral "settled between us"; the write-off on Day 55. Margo's arrival on Day 50 and her lock (C5) in v8.1's shape without the accusation.
5. **D2.** The ashes as decoy, still provisional ("for now"); the clock on file.
6. **D3.** The two letters as claims, side by side. The kind line reads: Brad paid me back the van money this autumn, every penny; the one thing this year that went right. No date, no "out of the blue".
7. **Part H.** The new public account for Fable's opening brief: the note, the letter that cleared them, "within a month they were sure it was one of them".

Then, if he rules it ready: Fable (fresh agent, given the file path, told to read Parts A to G and follow the prompt at the foot) and GPT (paste the whole file). File both verbatim as episode-1-spine-four-keys-v2.0-attack-{fable, chatgpt}-<date>.md. Disposition. Walk. If v2.0 survives, v8.1 is superseded and the blocked queue opens.

Standing rules

Never name a real chemical for the tin. Fable is never told Parts A to G except as the attack document. No em dashes anywhere. Terminology per v1.8 (the cookie barrel; "the tin" is tobacco only; AU copy "biscuit barrel" flagged). The first-minute test (two versions, three blind readers) stays parked until v2.0 is ruled.

Parked behind the premise

Both letters and the forgery as prose; Ruby's week-four line; chapter 2 line rulings; chapter 3 prose; the recut open to three readers; the two DRAFT banner lines and the Episode Closed summary; the headless EditMode run when the editor is closed (new tests and the leads-bar grouping unverified in play); the economy note.